Mapping The Intimate Body 1

Meeting Our Erotic Self

Sunday, June 16th 2024
with Cyndi Darnell

AGENDA

Welcome

Centering Practice

Breakout & Discussions

Waking Up The Body To Eros

Mapping The Genitals

Coaching Demo

Your Practice Turn - Triads

Questions

What is Sex, anyway?

Points of Discussion

- When you think of ‘sex’ - what do you think of?
- Why does that come to mind?
- Where did you first learn that that was ‘real’ sex?
- What effect does/did that have on how we conceptualize ‘sex’?
- How does this connect to the notion of pleasure?
- How helpful are these ideas in our personal lives and beyond?

What Brings Me Pleasure?

What is Pleasure?

- Pleasure is often associated with the satisfying of basic biological drives, like hunger, sexual desire, and social belonging.
- Pleasure can be found in appreciation of the arts, in music and dancing, and in religious and/or spiritual fervour.
- Pleasure's heights are often fleeting, and we can distinguish them because they surpass 'ordinary' experience. From a somatic perspective, I would add that:
- Pleasure fundamentally involves the body. Even the pleasure of an intellectually stimulating conversation can be felt in the body as well as the mind.

Meredith Reynolds. Healers on the Edge: Somatic Sex Education

What is Pleasure?

- Pleasure is about connection – with others, with ourselves, or with a sense of something greater than us. Though the experience of pleasure is highly individual, it is rarely in isolation.
- Though pleasure's heights may be fleeting, we can learn to expand our frequency and experience of pleasure so that it becomes an easily accessed presence

Meredith Reynolds. Healers on the Edge: Somatic Sex Education

What is Pleasure?

- Pleasure is also about indulgence, frivolity, distraction, excess, hedonism, indulgence, unhealthy, out of control, bad, naughty, lurid...SHAMEFUL

What is Pleasure?

- Pleasure limitation can present during coaching in many different ways – for example: numbness, oversensitivity, compulsion, and avoidance.
- Many people struggle to tolerate pleasure, to generate it reliably, and to feel good about feeling it.
- Many do not know how to cultivate it within themselves, instead looking almost exclusively to external sources for arousal, excitement and engagement.

What is Pleasure?

“What we must work on, it seems to me, is not so much to liberate our desires but to make ourselves infinitely more susceptible to pleasure”.

– Michel Foucault, from an interview published in the French magazine Gai Pied, April 1981

Creating and Inviting Pleasure

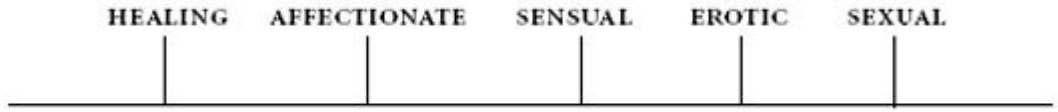
- Pleasure is a process. A skill. A practice we learn to invite in. We learn to give ourselves **permission for pleasure. Pleasure is an emotion and a sensation.**
- Pleasure is a birthright. It's simple in its essence but social conditions limit and destroy it.
- Coming back to the the body, making room for sensations including numbness, hunting for pleasure where there was once shame, fear or trauma takes time.
- Enhancing sensation by expanding pleasure with breath is helpful
- Upregulating breaths - longer in breathes than out breaths or breathing in and out through the mouth heightens sensation
- Downregulating breaths - longer exhales or breathing in and out through the nose assist with this.

Waking Up The Body

Waking Up The Body

- Touch & Sensation

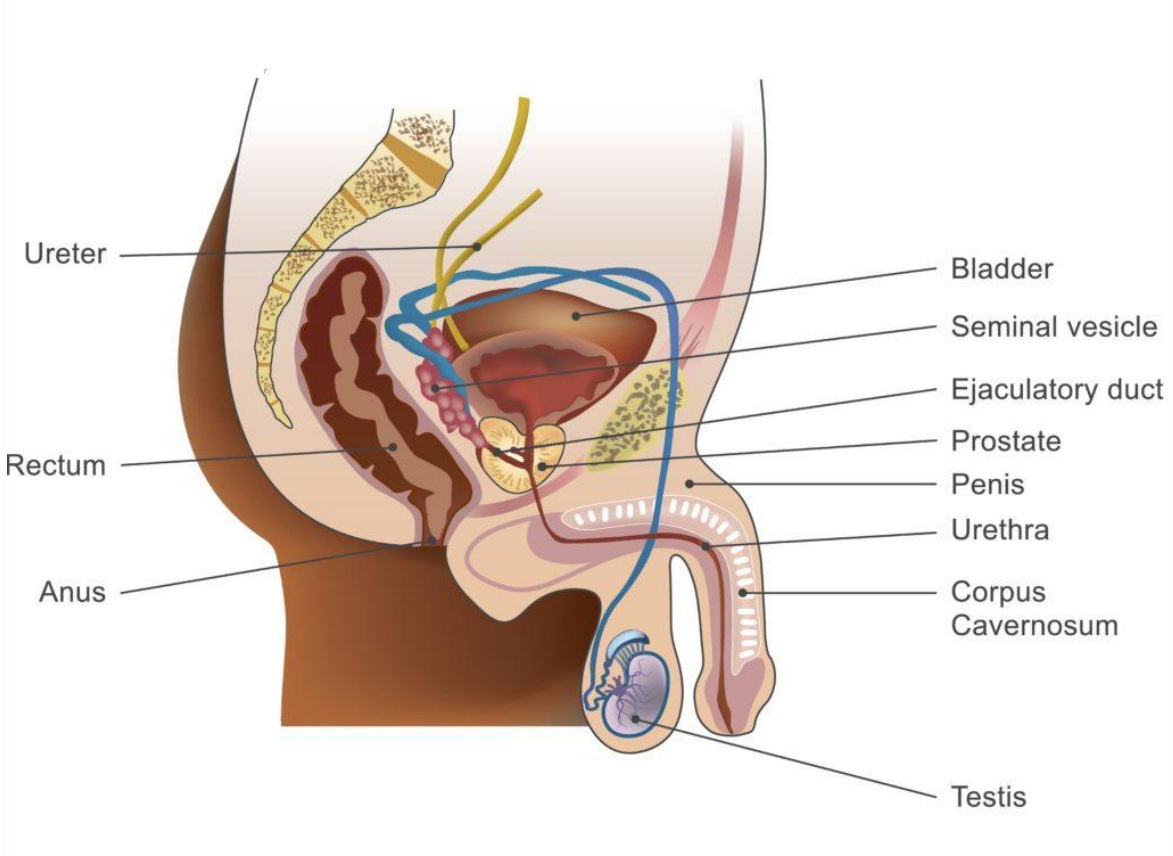
Figure 9.1 The Touch Continuum

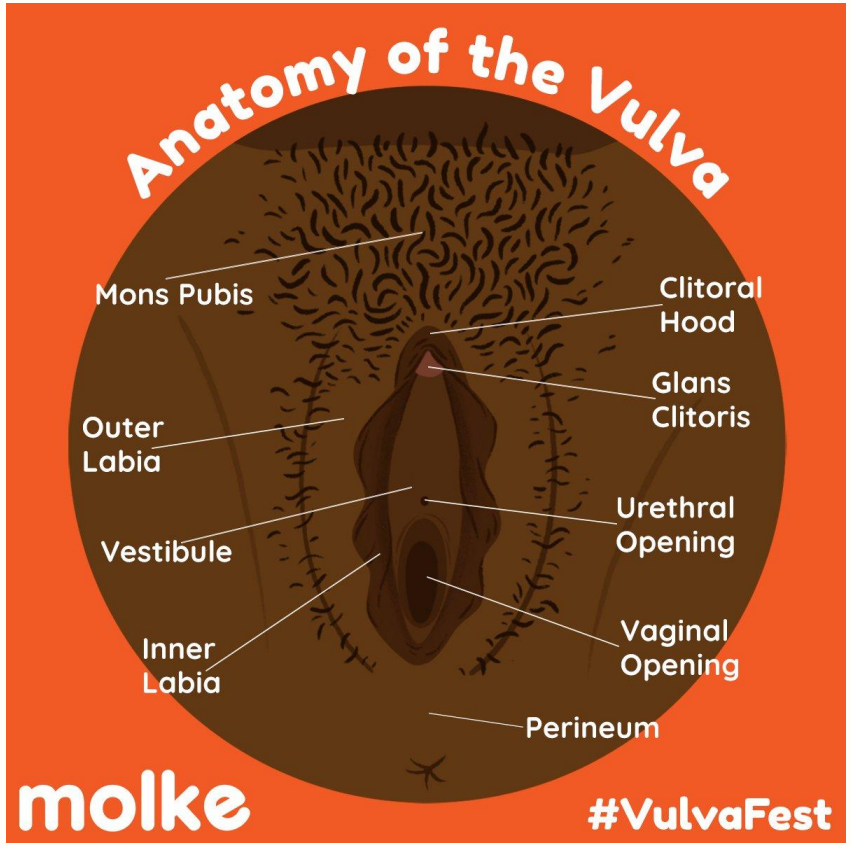


THE FIVE LEVELS OF TOUCH

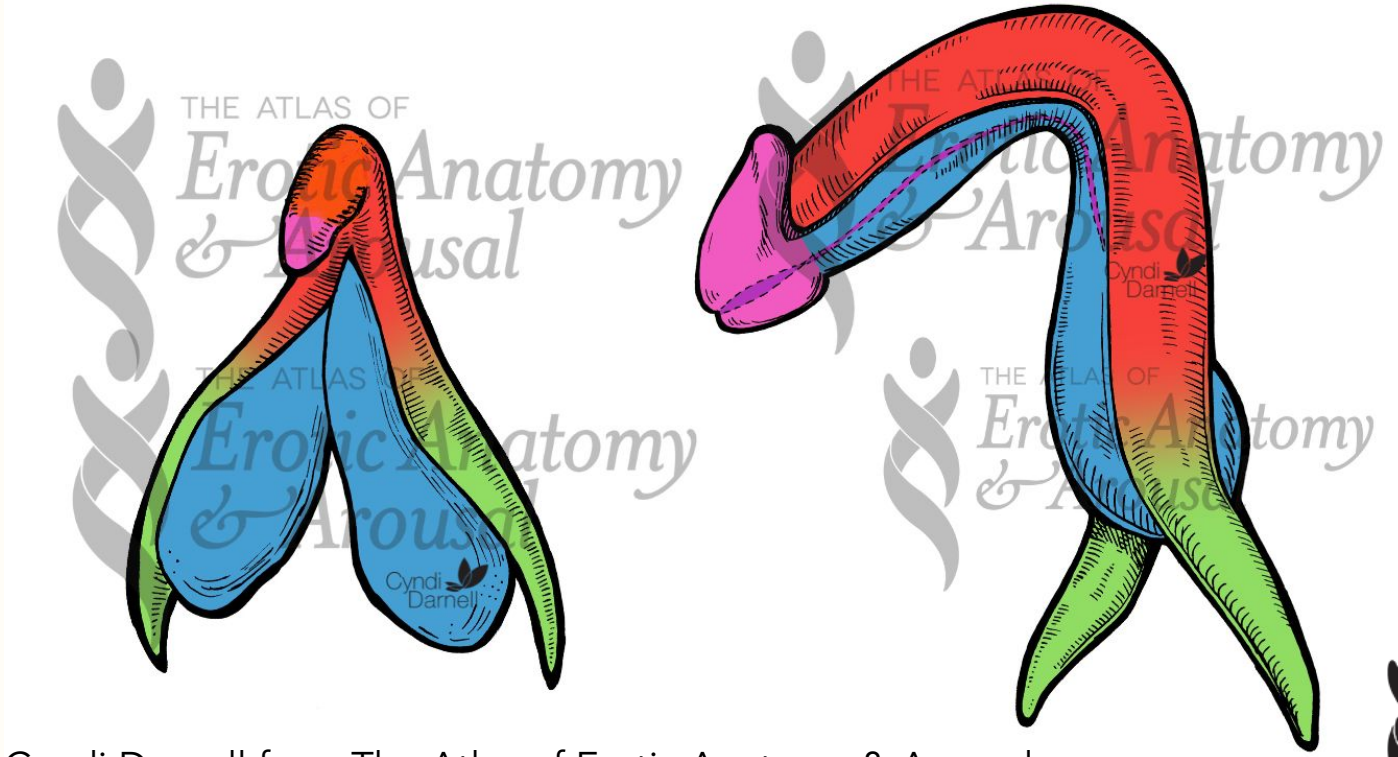
Mapping The Genitals

Mapping The Genitals





Mapping The Genitals



head /glans

shaft

bulbs

legs /crura

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DEMO

PRACTICE

QUESTIONS